

WKN D

ADVENTURE · REAL LIFE · WILD PLACES

BRAND GUIDELINES

The Trail Manual



VERSION 1.0 — SEPTEMBER 2026

BRAND AT A GLANCE

WKND Adventures is an editorial outdoor publication that documents the people, routes, and moments that make the outdoors worth protecting. This guide condenses positioning, editorial guardrails, voice, and the core visual system into one reference.

BOLD STORIES. REAL LIFE. WILD PLACES.

We write for the reader who is three weeks out and needs to know exactly what they're getting into. Every route is walked before it's written; every report carries a last-verified date. The tone is honest and field-tested — never brochure fluff, never gatekeeping.

DESIGN PRINCIPLES

- **Honest over hyped** — we publish the hard days, not just the summits: the bad weather, the route that didn't go, the gear that failed.
- **Field-first, not desk research** — specifics come from people who actually went.
- **For every level, no gatekeeping** — truthful difficulty ratings, welcoming to first-timers and alpinists alike.

KEY CHARACTERISTICS

- Photography-forward layouts built around full-bleed, dawn-and-dusk wilderness imagery.
- Wide display type meets clean sans body: **Syncopate** for headlines, **Instrument Sans** for reading.
- A trail-and-dusk palette — warm amber energy over deep pine, grounded in warm neutrals.
- Signature hard-offset "trail-sign" buttons and generously rounded cards.

MARKET POSITIONING

WKND Adventures is a first-hand adventure publication. It replaces endless research and secondhand trip reports with verified, walked-it-ourselves guides, gear, and field journals you can actually plan around.

POSITIONING STATEMENT

For serious outdoor people who are tired of aggregated, unverified beta, WKND Adventures is the first-hand publication that replaces guesswork with ground truth — real routes, real conditions, and real gear, documented in the field and updated when the trail changes. Unlike hype-driven wanderlust feeds, we publish only what we've confirmed ourselves.

AUDIENCE

- Serious outdoor people planning multi-day routes who need exact, current beta.
- Seasoned alpinists seeking detailed, honest accounts of routes they haven't done.
- Independent adventurers who plan their own trips rather than outsource them.

DIFFERENTIATORS

- **First-hand, not aggregated** — every route completed before publication.
- **Verified & dated** — each report carries a last-verified date.
- **Updated, not abandoned** — we revisit when conditions shift.
- **Honest difficulty** — truthful ratings, never gatekeeping.

CONTENT PILLARS

ADVENTURES

EXPEDITIONS

DESTINATIONS

FIELD NOTES

GEAR

COMMUNITY

EDITORIAL GUARDRAILS

Because WKND Adventures sends people into the real world — trails, water, weather, and remote places — every claim must protect the reader, the outdoors, and the publication's credibility. These guardrails are mandatory across all channels.

NON-NEGOTIABLE RULES

- **Walk it before you write it.** No route, camp, or crossing is published without a contributor completing it first.
- **Date every claim.** Conditions change — carry a last-verified date and revisit when the trail materially shifts. We treat outdated advice on active terrain as negligence.
- **Name the risk, skill, and conditions.** Encourage proper gear, training, and guides. Never frame danger as a challenge to prove.
- **Respect nature — Leave No Trace.** Promote low-impact travel. Never encourage off-trail damage, wildlife disturbance, or littering.
- **Be honest about difficulty.** Rate routes truthfully and inclusively; state the fitness, permits, and experience they require.
- **Respect people and place.** Honor local cultures, lands, and regulations, and ask readers to do the same.

APPROVED VS. PROHIBITED LANGUAGE

DO SAY

DON'T SAY

✓ "Best in late spring, when the snow line typically clears."

✗ "Perfect year-round — conditions guaranteed."

✓ "Intermediate — some exposed scrambling; bring sturdy boots."

✗ "Anyone can do it, no experience needed."

✓ "Check current conditions and permits before you go."

✗ "Just show up and go."

✓ "Last verified March 2026 — trail may have changed since."

✗ "Always accurate — trusted for life."

✓ "Pack out what you pack in — leave no trace."

✗ "Blaze your own trail wherever you like."

BRAND VOICE

WKND Adventures sounds like the contributor who already walked the route — honest, prepared, and generous with the details. It respects the reader's intelligence and their safety in equal measure.

VOICE ATTRIBUTES

- **Honest & first-hand** — specifics from experience, never brochure fluff.
- **Prepared & practical** — gear, timing, difficulty, and the next step.
- **Welcoming, not gatekeeping** — you belong out here, whatever your level.
- **Understated, not hyped** — the place is the drama; we don't manufacture it.
- **Responsible** — respects nature, safety, and local communities.

STYLE RULES

- Write for the reader who is three weeks out from the trip.
- Be specific: name the route, the season, the camp, the water source.
- Break trips into gear lists, day-by-day, and conditions — never a wall of text.
- Lead with the honest assessment, then the practical detail.

tone by context

Guides: exact, practical, verified. **Field Notes:** reflective, personal, vivid. **Community:** open, inclusive, celebratory.

voice in one line

"We go first, we document everything, and we update our work — so the outdoors you read about is the outdoors you'll actually find."

COLOUR PALETTE

The palette is the trail at dusk — warm amber energy against the deep pine of a forest at last light, grounded in warm, papery neutrals that let full-bleed photography carry the page.

PRIMARY & ACCENT

Trail Amber

#E8651A

Primary. CTAs, links, accents, energy and momentum.

Ember

#C8551A

Deep variant for hovers and high-contrast moments.

Deep Pine

#0F1A14

Primary dark background & body text — forest at dusk.

Pine Shadow

#3D4F45

Secondary text and muted green accents.

NEUTRALS

Bone

#F5F0E8

Warm light background & highlighted sections.

sand

#F0ECE4

Alternate surface, subtle panels and overlays.

Lichen

#7A8A80

Muted labels, captions, metadata.

snow

#FFFFFF

Cards on light, text on dark backgrounds.

TYPOGRAPHY

The pairing balances trail-sign boldness with editorial clarity:
Syncopate brings wide, deliberate energy to display and headings;
Instrument Sans keeps body and labels clean and highly readable.

DISPLAY

**FIND YOUR NEXT
TRAIL**

Syncopate · 700 · 40–56px · 1.05 line-height · uppercase

HEADLINE

BOLD STORIES. Real LIFE.

Syncopate · 700 · 26–34px · 1.1 line-height

TITLE

BACKCOUNTRY BASICS 101

Syncopate · 400 · 19–22px · 1.15 line-height

BODY

The best trips start with honest planning. Check the season, pack the right gear, and know the difficulty before you head out — then go make the most of it.

Instrument Sans · 400 · 16–18px · 1.6 line-height

LABEL / CTA

EXPLORE ADVENTURES

Syncopate · 700 · 11–13px · 0.07em tracking · uppercase

Never set long body copy in Syncopate, and avoid all-caps in reading paragraphs. Reserve uppercase for display, labels, and short calls to action.

SHAPE & COMPONENTS

Generous spacing and rounded, confident forms keep the brand approachable, while the signature hard-offset shadow gives every action a tactile, trail-sign snap. Let full-bleed photography carry the energy; keep structure calm so the outdoors is the hero.

BORDER RADIUS



8PX · STANDARD

Inputs, small controls



16PX · CARDS

Cards & panels



20PX · MEDIA

Feature & media tiles



PILL · BUTTONS

All calls to action

SPACING SCALE

4 tight · 8 component · 12 compact · 16 default gap · 24 card padding · 48 section spacing (px).

CORE COMPONENTS

EXPLORE ADVENTURES

READ FIELD NOTES

FIND A DESTINATION

BACKCOUNTRY BASICS 101

Learn to read conditions, pack smart, and pick a route that matches your level.

Accent: amber fill, dark label, pine shadow. **Primary:** pine fill, amber shadow. **Ghost:** outline with amber shadow. All shift on hover (shadow grows 3→5px, nudges up-left).

IMAGERY & MOTION

- Real, first-hand outdoor photography — dawn and golden-hour light, wide landscapes, people mid-adventure. No glossy staged stock.
- Let images run full-bleed; overlay text with a soft pine-to-transparent gradient for legibility.

WKND

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moments that make the outdoors worth protecting.



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